

BHASKAR PAUL



8 Extraa Noodles

In 2003, the World Cup action was on in South Africa, but it was Mandira Bedi's blouses that created a fashion furore in India. Bedi a.k.a. Plain Jane Shanti perched herself on SetMax's *Extraa Innings* and made the noodle-strap the new style buzzword (INDIA TODAY, March 2003). Purists were horrified. Some said her knowledge of cricket was hanging by her noodle straps. But the show's ratings zoomed. And cricket, all sexed-up, was never the same again.

6 Sexy Vixens

In 2000, Smriti Irani may have made the *saas-bahu* saga a national pastime but it was the vamps that made the right fashion noises. Urvashi Dholakia as Komolika in *Kasautii Zindagi Kay* with her garish make-up, satin saris and stylish *cholis* became the most copied TV star. Balaji stylist Nim Sood says, "I wanted her to show skin so I put her in off-shoulders, halters and backless blouses." Likewise, Sudha Chandran of *Kahiin Kissi Roz* portrayed her viciousness with her larger-than-life bindis. On the small screen, fashion favours the evil

7 Urban Flavour

The summer of 2001 changed the way Bollywood dressed. Farhan Akhtar's *Dil Chahta Hai* made the yuppie look an aspiration. The chest-hugging metrosexual shirts and Dior glasses worn by the actors in the film saw men stepping out, looking like models for sunglasses ads, noted INDIA TODAY in January 2004. The men loved their goatees and the women Preity Zinta's curls. Everyone wanted to look hip.



ARJIT SEN



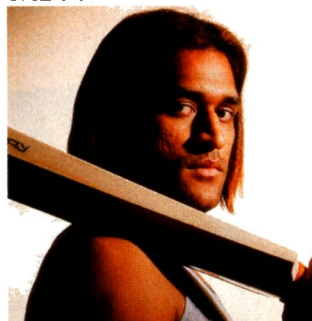
9 Babli Kurtis

Fashionwise, *Bunty Aur Babli* was hailed as the first real kitsch film, a fusion arising from the clash between south Mumbai and small-town India. Designer Aki Narula's fashion became the message, and not the film and its characters, noted INDIA TODAY in June 2005. If imitation is the best form of flattery, Narula spent most of 2005 flattered (INDIA TODAY, May 2005). His *pathani kurta* worn over flared Patiala salwar by Rani Mukerji for her con act in the film sent women running to their local tailor. The soon renamed Babli *kurtis* were in all possible pop colours, with rounded hemlines, contrasting cuffs and exaggerated collars. Designer Anupama Dayal says, "People would sheepishly come to me with cutouts and ask for something similar."

10 Hairstyles

After winning the first-ever T-20 World Cup in 2007, skipper Maheendra Singh Dhoni (MSD) was the man of the moment not just for his long innings at the crease, but also for his long locks. His busy schedule came in as a handy excuse for his hairstyle which had an ardent fan in Pakistan's ex-President Pervez Musharraf. As India moved up the rating chart, so did the popu-

BANDEEP SINGH



NEHA NATH

larity of Mahi's hairdo. But his short crop a few months later was also well received by his fans, who loved both the long and short of it. Before MSD left us on a high, model-turned-actor John Abraham had made waves with his long locks in *Jism* and *Dhoom*.

by Jhilmil Motihar